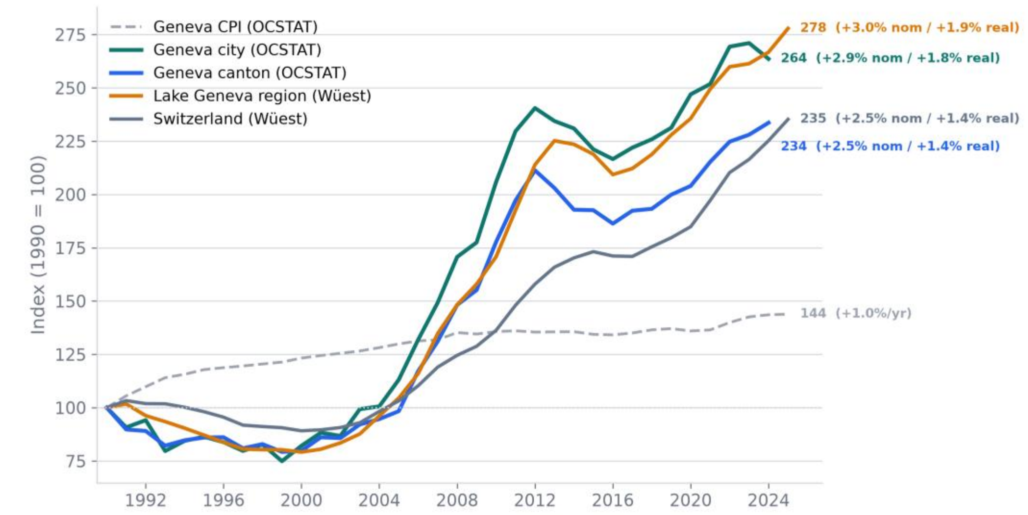
Geneva · Long-Term Price Dynamics · 1990–2025

All indices: 1990 = 100

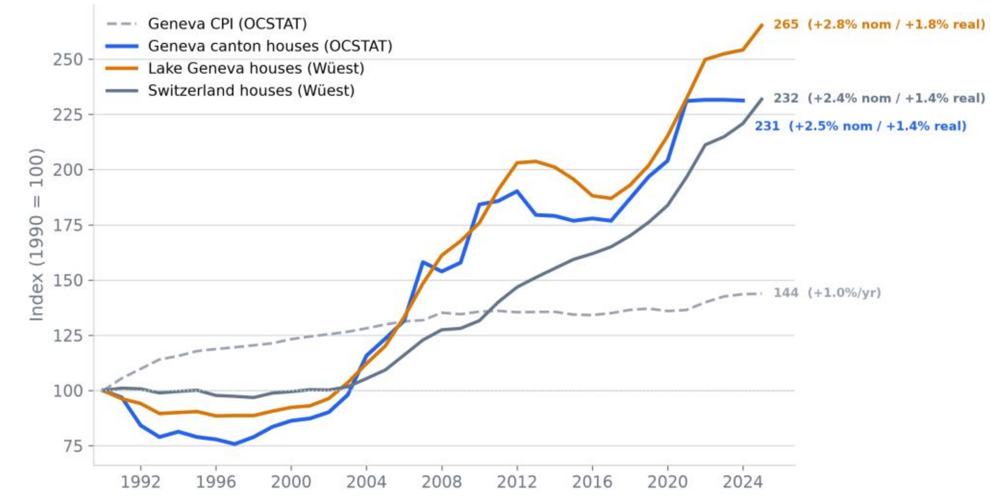
Three independent sources, one conclusion: Geneva real estate roughly tripled since 1990.

Apartment prices since 1990: Geneva city, canton and Swiss benchmarks



PPE: OCSTAT = calendar-year median CHF/m² (ensemble to 2005, existing+libre from 2006). Wüest = published annual hedonic TPI (1985=100), rebased 1990=100. End labels: nominal + real CAGR (Geneva CPI annual mean). | Sources: OCSTAT (transactions, CPI, construction); Wüest Partner (hedonic, not redistributed); BIS/FRED; BFS IMPI & construction · Author's calc.

House prices since 1990: Geneva canton vs Swiss benchmarks



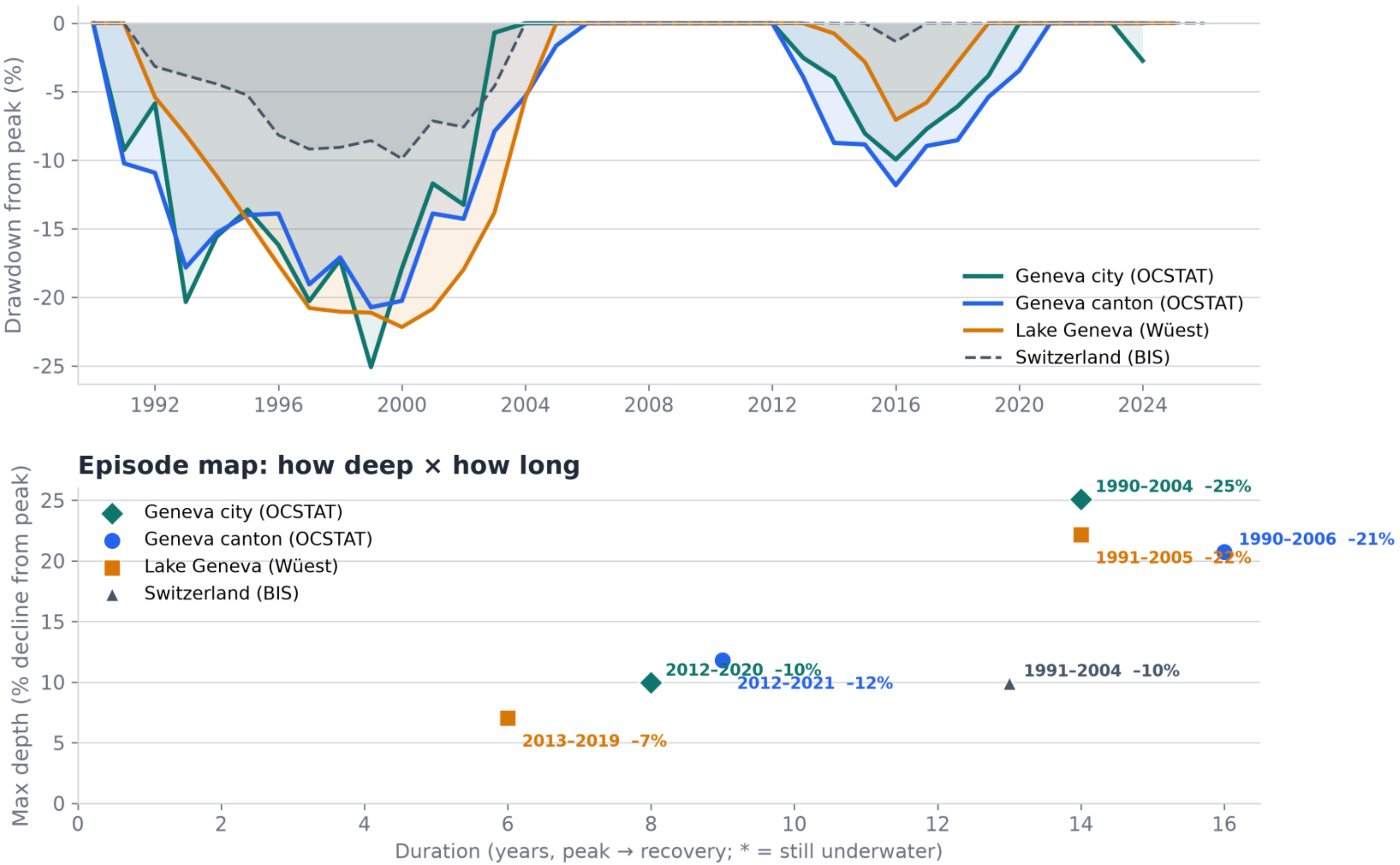
Houses only + Geneva CPI. OCSTAT = median CHF/object; real CAGR uses Geneva CPI. Not level-comparable to PPE CHF/m². | Sources: OCSTAT (transactions, CPI, construction); Wüest Partner (hedonic, not redistributed); BIS/FRED; BFS IMPI & construction · Author's calc.

- Apartments: city +2.9%/yr nominal (+1.8% real), canton +2.5%/yr (+1.4% real) over 34 years. Houses: canton +2.5%/yr, Lake Geneva region +2.8%/yr. Prices roughly double every 25–28 years in nominal terms.
- Official OCSTAT transactions and Wüest hedonic index show the same trajectory (correlation 0.99 on levels, 74–90% direction agreement). The trend is not an artifact of one measurement method.
- Geneva follows the Swiss cycle but amplifies it: deeper corrections, steeper rises. CPI grew just +1.0%/yr — real estate outpaced inflation by +1.4–2.0 percentage points annually.

Sources: OCSTAT (notarial transactions, Canton of Geneva); Wüest Partner (hedonic index, not redistributed); BIS/FRED; BFS IMPI · Author's calculations

Drawdowns from peak: depth and duration

Apartments (PPE)



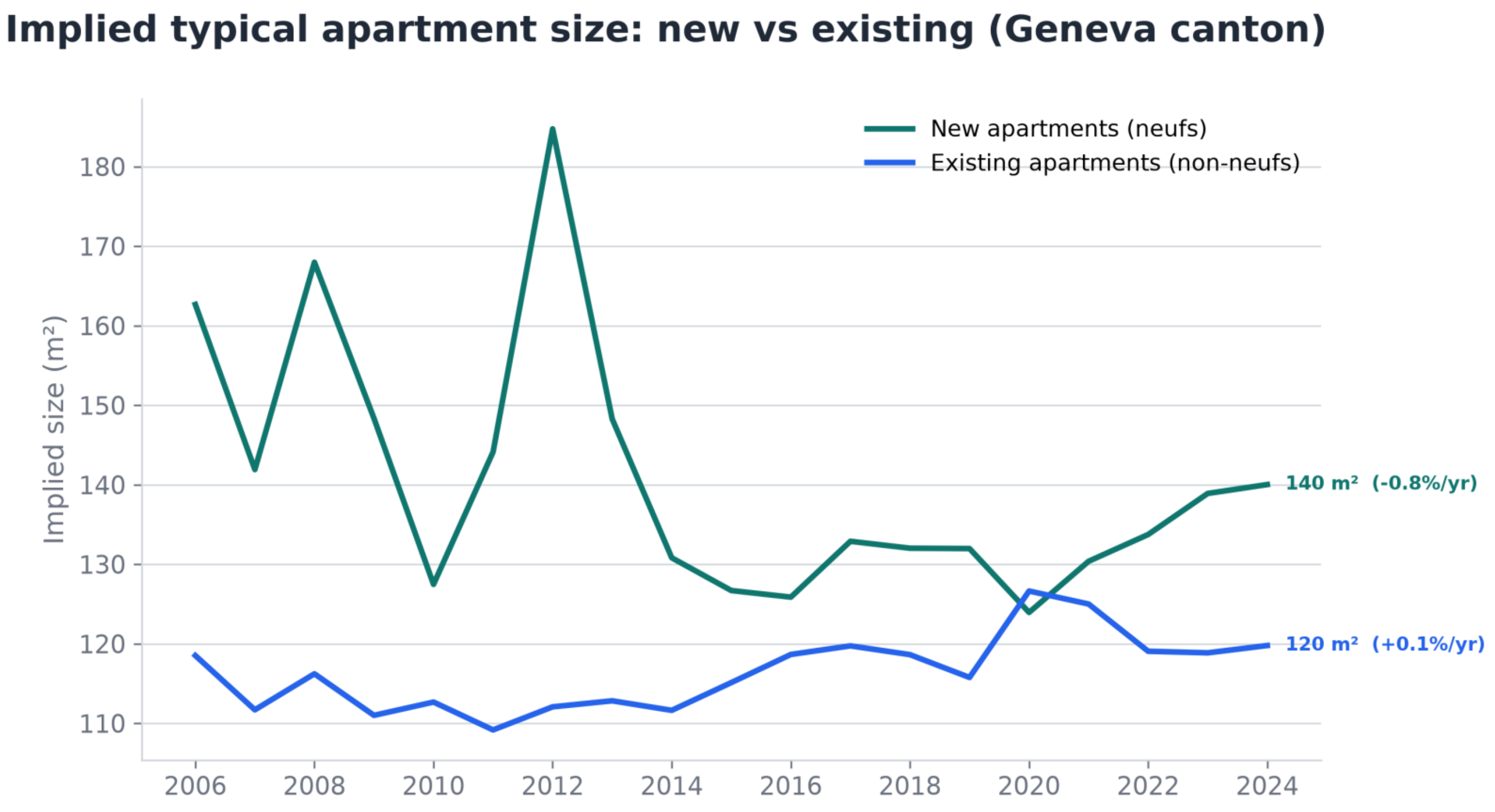
Drawdown = % below running peak of index (1990=100). Episodes with depth ≥ 3%. Apartments (PPE) series. | Sources: OCSTAT (transactions, CPI, construction); Wüest Partner (hedonic, not redistributed); BIS/FRED; BFS IMPI & construction · Author's calc.

- Worst case: Geneva city fell −25% from peak and took 14 years to recover (1990–2004). Canton: −21%, 16 years. Switzerland nationally: only −10% — Geneva amplifies the cycle 2×.
- The second cycle (2012–2021) was milder: −10 to −12%, recovery in 6–9 years. Shorter, shallower — potentially a more resilient market or different rate environment.
- After every drawdown, the new peak substantially exceeded the previous one. Long-term holders were always rewarded — but the holding period matters.

What Size Apartment Is Actually Selling?

Geneva canton · 2006–2024

Proxy: median object price ÷ median CHF/m² — the implied typical floor area of a sold apartment.



Proxy: OCSTAT median object price (kCHF)×1000 / median CHF/m², same segment (T 05.05.1.4.01). Not median floor area. Neufs vs non-neufs from 2006. End labels: level + CAGR over available span. | Sources: OCSTAT (transactions, CPI, construction); Wüest Partner (hedonic, not redistributed); BIS/FRED; BFS IMPI & construction · Author's calc.

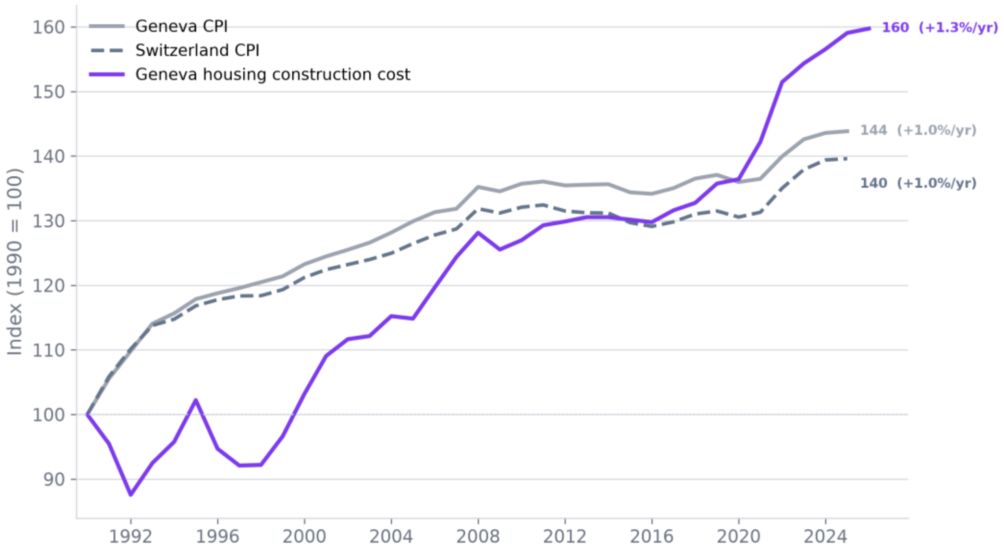
- Existing apartments: ~120 m², remarkably stable (+0.1%/yr over 18 years). The composition of what sells has barely changed — a consistent market for 3–4 room flats.
- New apartments: ~140 m² in 2024, trending upward since 2014 (from ~125 m²). Developers are building larger, higher-value units. Early years (2006–2012) show high volatility due to small sample sizes.
- New apartments are ~17% larger than existing. This is a proxy (ratio of two medians, not median floor area directly), but the direction is consistent with market observations.

Inflation, Construction Costs & Growth Summary

All indices: 1990 = 100

Real estate outpaced inflation by +1.4–2.0 p.p./year. Construction costs surged after 2020.

Inflation and construction costs: Geneva vs Switzerland



Geneva CPI and Switzerland CPI (T 05.02.02, annual mean). Geneva housing construction cost (T 05.03.1.01). No transaction prices — see lr_01 / lr_06. | Sources: OCSTAT (transactions, CPI, construction); Wüest Partner (hedonic, not redistributed); BIS/FRED; BFS IMPI & construction · Author's calc.

Geography	Source	Index (1990=100)	Nominal /year	Real /year
APARTMENTS (PPE, CHF/m²)				
Geneva city	OCSTAT	264	+2.9%	+1.8%
Geneva canton	OCSTAT	234	+2.5%	+1.4%
Lake Geneva region	Wüest	278	+3.0%	+1.9%
Switzerland	Wüest	235	+2.5%	+1.4%
HOUSES (CHF/object)				
Geneva canton	OCSTAT	232	+2.4%	+1.4%
Lake Geneva region	Wüest	265	+2.8%	+1.8%
Switzerland	Wüest	231	+2.5%	+1.4%
INFLATION & COSTS				
Geneva CPI	OCSTAT	144	+1.0%	—
Switzerland CPI	BFS	140	+1.0%	—
Geneva construction cost	OCSTAT	160	+1.3%	—

- Geneva CPI +1.0%/yr, construction costs +1.3%/yr (with a sharp acceleration after 2020). Real estate nominal growth of +2.5–3.1%/yr translates to +1.4–2.0%/yr above inflation.
- Construction cost surge (+18% in 4 years) supports the new-build price premium and limits future supply growth — a structural tailwind for existing property values.
- Data: OCSTAT (official notarial transactions), Wüest Partner (hedonic quality-adjusted index), BIS/FRED, BFS IMPI. Full methodology and code: GitHub.